

**Regular Meeting
Monday, December 3, 2018
Medford School Committee
Council Chambers**

Present: Ms. DiBenedetto, Ms. Mustone, Mr. Ruseau, Ms. Van der Kloot, Mr. Ruggiero, Mayor Burke, Superintendent Dr. Edouard-Vincent, Associate Superintendent Ms. Caldwell, Assistant Superintendent of Finance Ms. Patterson, and Jasper Su, High School Representative

Mayor Burke – Called meeting to order at 7:04 PM, Secretary please call the roll.

Attendance – 7 – present 0 – absent

Approval of Minutes of November 19, 2018 – Motion to approve offered by Mr. Ruggiero, seconded by Ms. Mustone, motion passes.

Approval of Bills/Transfer of Funds. Question about Title I grant. Motion to approve offered by Ms. Kreatz, seconded by Mr. Ruseau, motion passes.

Approval of payrolls – Motion to approve offered by Ms. DiBenedetto, seconded by Ms. Van der Kloot, motion passes.

Report of the Secretary – Ms. Kreatz went over the list of educational toys purchased for students.

Motion to accept the secretary's report and place on file, by Ms. DiBenedetto, seconded by Ms. Mustone, motion passes.

Report of Committees - On November 6 we had a meeting in which we were given homework to update our rules document. We had a Rules Subcommittee meeting just before this meeting and made a motion to have an updated draft of the rules document for the next meeting. Please disregard the draft in your packets tonight.

Motion to accept Rules Subcommittee Report and place on file by Ms. Mustone, seconded by Ms. Van der Kloot, motion passes.

Report of the Superintendent - Dr. Edouard-Vincent - Thank you to the Curtis Tufts school principal, staff, and students for hosting us for a Thanksgiving dinner, it was a great event. On Wednesday I attended the pep rally at Medford High School. It was a wonderful event. I also attended the football game on Thanksgiving. Our players have heart, Thanksgiving was one of the coldest on record and our team gave it their all. We had a tough loss but it was very close. Special thanks to Coach Nascimento, the players, the family members and school committee members who braved the cold. Go Mustangs! On Monday after Thanksgiving break we had our second retreat with School Committee.

We had rich discussions with Dorothy Presser from MASC and Dr. Karla Behr, my coach from NSIP, laying the foundation of what's to come and my district goals. Thank you for participating in that with me. This past Friday, we had our official ribbon cutting for the new basketball court and scoreboard. Lesley's basketball team attended the ceremony. We had a successful Girls on the Run program last Saturday at Hormel Stadium. Girls from the McGlynn Elementary and the Roberts participated. Thanks to Meghan Richard and coaching staffs from both schools. Last week 6 Medford High athletes and 2 coaches attended an event at Gillette stadium about the importance of sportsmanship. This is a reminder about the event honoring Lena DiGiantommaso. Thank you to Erin DiBenedetto and Michael Marks for their dedication to this project. We are continuing to work collaboratively with the city and board of health on social emotional development. Our winter sports programming has officially started. We are entering the season of giving. Medford Public Schools will be hosting many events. Medford High Band is selling Christmas trees. Medford High and McGlynn elementary and City Hall are collecting Toys for Tots. Medford Family Network continues with the mitten trail to assist families in need. MVTHS is working with Medford Rotary to put together food baskets. Non-perishable food items are being collected. Mustang Key Club is also collected canned food for those in need. Medford Family Network is hosting a toy drive at Real Gusto on December 5 at 6pm. Medford Mustang Mall at the high school, hosted by Medford Vocational students in the marketing program, have extended holiday shopping hours: 7:15am to 4pm. We had our own Kathy Medaglio and a parent Melanie McLaughlin on NPR in a story titled Medford Schools Working to Improve Emergency Plans for Students with Disabilities.

Report on Superintendent's goals - Dr. Edouard-Vincent - DESE has an expectation that all educators have goals and I have shared my improvement goals with you here. These goals overlap and address the work I talked to you about in my entry plan. Effective entry and direction setting: by late spring the district will understand its most critical needs and develop strategies to address them. The next report will come from me in February on the status of the entry plan findings. The next goal is developing a district-wide focus on instruction, working with district leaders to develop a common language and strategy for discussion. We will have consistent language on instruction and evaluating teachers. In this document I detail the learning walks I will continue to conduct. I will continue to collaborate with Lesley University. I will conduct at least 5 classroom visits at each school. My expectation is to continue looking at instruction in schools. By the end of this year I will have taken the time to introduce these core actions to administrators and teachers. My focus for this year is to improve elementary achievement outcomes in mathematics by deepening teacher and principal knowledge of mathematics, supporting the math coaching program, and continued development in partnership with Lesley University. Our second formal walk will be in January. There will be high-level, targeted professional development in mathematics. I have an ambitious goal of seeing an increase in student performance from 40.6%, hoping to move to 45%: approximately 10% of our third through fifth graders. My last goal is to complete the NSIP program. Ms. Van der Kloot - on the key actions for district improvement number 3, can you say by mid-May instead of by June? It's essential that we have time to hear strategies and know what the

budget impact will be. Dr. Edouard-Vincent - I will make that adjustment. Mr. Ruggiero - When you meet with Lesley about scheduling the tutor program can I sit in or hear about those meetings? Dr. Edouard-Vincent - Yes. Mr. Ruseau - Benchmark on MCAS math increase: was there a rubric you used to pick that number? Dr. Edouard-Vincent - I worked with my NSIP mentor Dr. Behr on the benchmark. We made an investment as a district in math tutors and each school receives coaching 2 full days a week. We expect to see an outcome from that investment. There is a focus on math and opportunities have been afforded and the goal is ambitious because I want to push the bar. Ms. DiBenedetto - When you joined us you said you wanted to focus on mathematics and I wanted to acknowledge that you stated that at the very beginning and this is not arbitrary. When we review you as a committee we should look back at this and see how successful you've been, I expect you will overshoot your goals. Ms. Van der Kloot - I have a word change suggestion. Developing a district wide focus on instruction: By working with principals and other district leaders we will develop a common language about instruction which will be used as the foundation for improving instruction. Dr. Edouard-Vincent - Thank you. Jasper Su - This focus on math is great and as a National Honor Society member I would like to offer our services to tutor elementary school students at the high school. Dr. Edouard-Vincent - Thank you, I appreciate that creative thinking.

Ms. DiBenedetto - Medford High Mall extended hours to 4. As a PTO member I used to open the mall at 6 or 7 at night for parents to buy gifts. Can we do that again? Even one night? Do they take credit cards or is it cash only? Dr. Edouard-Vincent - They take credit and I will look into extended hours and post it on the website and blog. Ms. DiBenedetto - And the Key Club, you said they're doing a canned food drive. Will they do caroling? Dr. Edouard-Vincent - Tony can you speak to that? I can follow up to find out and get it advertised as well.

Mayor Burke - on the motion by Ms. Van der Kloot to accept Dr. Edouard-Vincent's report on goals and place it on file, seconded by Ms. DiBenedetto, motion passes.

Report on MASC Conference - Ms. Van der Kloot - We attended the conference where the new Commissioner of Education spoke. He seemed concerned with the whole child. I would like to get the Commissioner to Medford to show him our social emotional development work. We found at the conference that issues important to Medford are important to other school committee members from other cities. On the motion of Ms. DiBenedetto to accept this report and place it on file, seconded by Ms. Mustone, motion passes.

Recognition of Christopher Walsh and Arden Ingersoll – Mr. Szykniej – I am very pleased to announce that these two students were selected to perform in the Senior Festival Conference. It is the second year in a row that both have been selected. Senior Christopher Walsh on percussion and Senior Arden Ingersoll on string bass with all-state recommendation. Mayor Burke – Medford is proud to recognize both students.

Mayor Burke – We now have a grand announcement from the Medford High School Band. Ms. Rello – Medford Mustang Marching Band has been invited to participate in the summer of 2020 to celebrate the 75th anniversary of the end of World War II. We have been chosen to represent the Commonwealth of Massachusetts. We are representing Medford and also Massachusetts, which is a big deal. The only other band in our area to travel to Hawaii was Danvers High School in 2001. We will be in the parade, on deck of the USS Missouri, participating in a wreath ceremony to honor the 224 residents of Medford who lost their lives in World War II. There will be lots of performance opportunities and educational opportunities and documentaries. Mayor Burke – What an amazing opportunity to represent not only Medford but Massachusetts. Ms. DiBenedetto – Congratulations to everyone who made this possible. All students need to take out insurance when they travel. Ms. Rello – The insurance wasn't included because I wanted to keep costs down. I can include it. Ms. DiBenedetto – The policy was changed years ago because a trip had to be canceled. We don't want anything to happen to have to cancel and parents are spending a lot of money. Ms. Van der Kloot – This is a very exciting opportunity for the band, it is thrilling to watch the band get better and better with every performance. Congratulations to you and every member. Mr. Ruseau – The dates are December 4-9, 2020. If a family went together, do the kids have to go home with the whole group? Ms. Rello – There are different policies. You can sign your student over. Some parents want to go as a vacation and want to stay longer. You sign your student out of my care and into your care. From that point on, they are their parent's responsibility. Mr. Ruggiero – Was there a competition? Ms. Rello – I applied two years ago. We sent in an audition tape, did forms, paper work, and wrote an essay on why Medford should represent the Commonwealth and we were selected. We are planning on documenting the whole trip and reaching out to the community. I'm hoping to do a free public presentation with a slide show and have students talk about what they learned. Mr. Ruggiero – A number of residents who spend time at the senior center are veterans of World War II and I recommend that you connect with them. Ms. Rello – Yes that's the plan. Ms. Kreatz – Congratulations and to reiterate, I would like to attend. Ms. Mustone – Will middle schoolers be open to the trip or is it strictly high school? Ms. Rello – We are the Mustang Marching Band, not just the high school. Students over a certain age will be allowed to attend. 7th grade and up is usually fine. Parents can sign off on it. We will have a parent meeting to look at current 7th, 8th, 9th, and 10th graders. Most of the band that would be going is not in band yet, so it's hard to plan. We have a year and a half to change members. Motion to approve field trip as amended. Roll call vote – 7 in the affirmative, 0 in the negative, motion passes.

Update on Enrollment Report – Ms. Patterson – This is a follow up to the October 1 report. We separated the information with demographics. Student counts are used for chapter 70 funding. We successfully filed all state reports for student information through DESE. We are in good shape. Mr. Ruseau – This report says there were 77 kindergarteners at the Brooks. The DESE website will not show that for a year. Ms. Patterson – Yes, the current data is for the previous year's numbers. It's always important that we have every child counted prior to the October 1 snapshot because that determines our funding. Ms. DiBenedetto – The Roberts students have a big jump, is that because of

ELL students having a year at the Columbus and then going back to Roberts? Ms. Patterson – That is true, but that's not why. We had a bubble in that grade that year. Ms. DiBenedetto – is it possible to break out numbers of homeless families? I'm curious where we are in Medford. It doesn't have to be tonight, I'm just curious for a snapshot. Can we get that at a later date? Ms. Patterson – we can only provide information for our students, not families. Just a count of students. Ms. DiBenedetto – Okay. Mr. Ruggiero – I'm curious about the ratio of special education students in Pre-K. That seems like a big proportion, is that normal? Also male to female ratio? Kathy Medaglio – Pre-K programs in Medford are developed as special education programs. They contain 50% typically developing children so there is a high percentage of special education. We develop our Pre-K programs for special education. If anyone in the community is interested in Pre-K here in Medford, we still have room available. Mayor Burke – Pre-K is 4-year-olds? Ms. Medaglio - We will take 3-year-olds who are independent enough. Ms. DiBenedetto – both my children were in those classrooms. Both learned a lot. Ms. Medaglio – In 1990 my child was in that program too.

Mayor Burke on the motion of Ms. Van der Kloot to accept this report and place on file, seconded by Mr. Ruseau, motion passes.

Fiscal 2018 Closeout – Ms. Patterson – This is a summary of the closeout of the prior fiscal year. Athletics is a program known to be in a deficit. The fee structure is limited. Athletic programs are popular but we don't have an excessive amount charged to subsidize programs. We have to know as a district that athletics are routinely having to be covered by the general fund to close out. Areas of savings were ELL, reporting distinctions for end of year. Special education transportation within the general fund came out lower. We had some savings there. Vocational school out-of-district tuitions, we had fewer students attending so applicable transport costs were lower than expected. Utility usage contracts were favorable so we had some savings in those areas that were able to balance the overall budget. Ms. DiBenedetto – Beginning balances started in a negative amount? Ms. Patterson – Yes, this is how you do financial reporting. In parenthesis is positive. Ms. DiBenedetto – In future can you give us the balance on that amount? The total on that column? Mayor Burke – The net total. Ms. Patterson – Okay. Ms. DiBenedetto – On page 3 does it say schools didn't use budget items for textbooks? Ms. Patterson – Yes. Ms. DiBenedetto – Some people didn't order in time. Ms. Patterson – Yes, but they did get training. Textbooks should be purchased early in the year. We encourage them to monitor and review the requirements. Ms. DiBenedetto – Didn't we increase the athletics budget? Ms. Patterson – We increased for FY19, and not to the place where the ultimate need is, we will still need offsets. When teams are successful there are additional fees. Ms. DiBenedetto – I want to keep moving forward with increasing the budget so people don't think we are not funding athletics. Mr. Ruseau – A question about the deficit for athletics. It says \$21. Ms. Patterson – I had to move the money there to cover the amount. They start from zero, take in revenue that is not enough to cover what we need to expend. Mr. Ruseau – What do we spend per student on various types of athletics? Is our expenditure rational? Ms. Patterson – we have many programs in a revolving fund. Each program may have a different value. One may lose and another

may do better, that's how they offset in terms of program area. Mayor Burke – Even within athletics, football is more per students than gymnastics or soccer. Mr. Ruseau – But if the gymnastics team has to fundraise and the football team has to do nothing that's not fair. I want to get a sense of how much it costs to be a soccer player, how much fundraising each person has to do, how much Medford is giving from our taxes to each student to be a soccer player. I want to identify inequities. I've seen some fundraising going on and I wonder if they do anything else. Ms. Patterson – there is fundraising going on outside of our coffers. We are not the only source of funding for these programs. There is no consistent cost for everything, it's totally different dollar values and even within programs. Different instruments have different requirements. Providing student cost per pupil per item, plus overhead, it's hard to calculate. The revolving funds carry it. The cost/charge we're implementing, there is still overhead for running that program. It won't look consistent because it's not apples to apples. Mr. Ruseau – Are we being fair, rational, and considerate in the current model? One place they're getting funding is in this part of the budget. I can't affect how the band raises money in the community, but every year athletics runs a big deficit, is anybody else running a big deficit? Does athletics have 1,000 students and the deficit is rational for 1,000 students? Ms. Patterson – We can get the participation level for you for last year. Mr. Ruseau – The PTO process should be laid out here too. The number of participants, and how much did they raise. Ms. Patterson – That's outside of school coffers. It won't be on our documents. You can see that information from the reports of the 501(c)3s. Mr. Ruggiero – I would also like to see participation rates. Page 6 math teacher allocation: are certain schools getting more money for math? Ms. Patterson – It's all different factors. New hires, etc. Mr. Ruggiero – Do we have a sense of different school district's budgets? Do they do breakdowns as fine as this? Ms. Patterson – Yes, DESE has that information. Mr. Ruggiero – Does a program do this report? Ms. Patterson – It's the city's financial system. Mr. Ruggiero – Can you email it? Ms. Patterson – The state provides that, you can identify which districts you want to compare. Mr. Ruggiero – Can you send us this as a pdf? Mayor Burke – The formula wouldn't work. Ms. Patterson – I can scan it and send it to you as a pdf. Mr. Ruggiero – I'll figure it out.

Mayor Burke on the motion of Ms. Kreatz to accept the report and place on file, seconded by Ms. Van der Kloot, motion passes.

PTO Update – Ms. Patterson - Emily Lazzaro will maintain the listing and contact information for fundraising entities. We will maintain the listing on an annual basis. The Attorney General's Office is offering a webinar-based training to roll out across the state in mid-January. I will share the exact time line. We will be one of the first to receive training. Ms. DiBenedetto – We have the Google form and it's been approved. I want to move forward with current PTOs and Friends Of accounts to start using them. Motion to continue what we voted on for October 1 for all our groups to be on that line and facilitated by Emily Lazzaro by February 1, 2019. Ms. Van der Kloot – Is what we developed consistent with what the state is doing? Ms. Patterson – We have to rely on the entities to self-report. We might not have searched for them. Groups that are affiliated need to report to the Superintendent's office. We can put the start out there and provide

what we are able to get from the AG's website. Ms. Van der Kloot – There is no reason not to go ahead with the form we developed? Ms. Patterson – No, it's a simple form. Dr. Edouard-Vincent – We have the form, we are just saying we are going to handle it within the office. Ms. DiBenedetto – It should be mandatory, not voluntary, that they submit these forms or they can't raise funds for Medford students. They have to register with us. This will be reported at the end of February.

Mayor Burke - On the motion that 501(c)3 registration occur no later than February 1, 2019 by Ms. DiBenedetto, seconded by Ms. Van der Kloot. Roll call vote. 7 - affirmative, 0 - negative, motion passes.

Mayor Burke - Ms. Van der Kloot makes a motion to move Negotiations and Legal Matters to the end of the calendar, Mr. Ruseau seconds the motion. Motion carries.

The Medford School Committee offers its condolences to the families of Mary Anne Cremins, a teacher at the Swan School in Medford for over 37 years, as well as to the family of President George H. W. Bush, the 41st President of the United States of America.

Mayor Burke - Motion to go into Executive Session made by Ms. Mustone, seconded by Mr. Ruggiero.

Roll Call Vote - 7 - affirmative, 0 - negative, motion passes.

Mayor Burke - We will enter executive session now - 8:34 PM.

Per Secretary Kathy Kreatz - Executive session ended at 9:09 PM and all members were in attendance.